

COMMUNITY INTEREST COMPANY · WEEKEND SESSIONS

Show up for yourself. Get your deposit back.

Dance-fitness and wellbeing sessions for absolutely everyone. You pay a small refundable deposit to book. You turn up. It comes straight back to you. No membership, no contract, no catch.

[Join the waitlist](#)[Discover the benefits](#)

All fitness levels Beginners welcome Refund by bank transfer

— ABOUT US

Health inequality is the injustice nobody talks about.

The ethos of the Confidence Academy is very simple: participants get their money back once they attend their selected fitness and wellbeing events.

When you show up for your health, when you show up for yourself... your refund is your reward.

RAYHANA SULTAN · FOUNDER & DIRECTOR

The Confidence Academy exists to make the tools of confidence-building (through improved nutrition, better mental and physical fitness, and community support) accessible to all, particularly to struggling and marginalised communities who often feel invisible or left behind. Health inequality is one of the biggest injustices of them all that we don't talk about, yet our health is the sole foundation of our existence.

The inception of this CIC is driven by the fact that **nearly 60% of the UK population in 2023/24 were reported as obese or overweight.** This is a national crisis in a context where our healthcare system is overstretched, support for mental health is not on par, which can be exacerbated by health-related problems, and an ageing population is awaiting us. Growing old, or not being able to afford the regular gym, should not mean fitness services are inaccessible to you. So we are here to change it.

— BENEFITS

Good for your body. Better for your head. Best with other people.

Our sessions are built around Zumba and dance fitness: movement that feels like a night out rather than a workout. Here is what you actually get out of it.



Physical health

Moving to music is one of the easiest ways to get active and stay active, because you forget you are exercising.

- ✓ More movement in your week, without a gym
- ✓ Improved cardiovascular fitness
- ✓ Better coordination, balance and mobility
- ✓ More energy day to day
- ✓ A genuinely fun alternative to traditional exercise



Mental health & confidence

Confidence is not something you either have or you don't. It is built, one session at a time, usually while laughing.

- ✓ Confidence that carries beyond the room
- ✓ A real lift in mood
- ✓ Stress relief and headspace
- ✓ Room to express yourself, badly or brilliantly
- ✓ Motivation that sticks, and feeling good about yourself



Community & social

Most people arrive on their own. Almost nobody leaves feeling like they came on their own.

- ✓ Meet new people from your area
- ✓ Build real friendships
- ✓ Feel part of something local
- ✓ Exercise together instead of alone
- ✓ A welcoming, supportive room, always

— WHY TCA IS DIFFERENT

We are not a gym. We are a community interest company.

The Confidence Academy exists because health inequality is real, and because being unable to afford a gym should not mean being unable to look after yourself.

The deposit-refund model

You book with a refundable deposit rather than a fee. Attend, and it comes back to you.

No traditional barrier to entry

No membership, no joining fee, no twelve-month contract, no direct debit you forget to cancel.

A CIC mission, not a profit motive

We are a Community Interest Company. What we hold back goes towards keeping sessions running.

Accessibility first

Built for people who feel invisible in ordinary fitness spaces, including those coming back after a long time away.

Committed to community wellbeing

Fitness sessions sit alongside nutrition and wellbeing education, mindset workshops and open community conversations.

Self-accountability, gently

The deposit is not a punishment. It is a small promise to yourself that makes showing up more likely.

Who are the sessions for?

Everyone. That is not marketing language; it is the whole point.

● Everyone

● All fitness levels

● Complete beginners

● Returning to exercise

— DEPOSIT-REFUND MODEL

Your money comes back when you do.

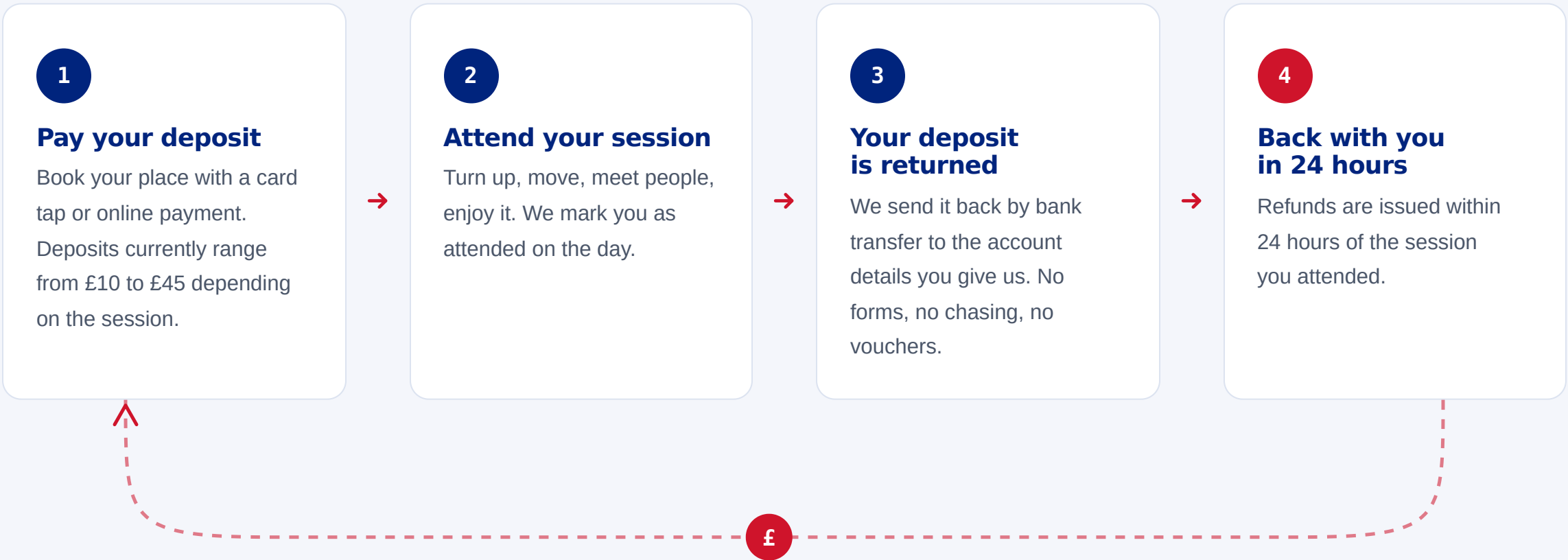
This is the part people ask about most, so here it is in plain English. You are not paying for a class. You are leaving a deposit, and collecting it when you attend.

Why we use a deposit

- ✓ **Commitment.** A booking you have skin in is a booking you keep.
 - ✓ **Accessibility.** Nobody is priced out by a monthly membership.
 - ✓ **Reliable attendance.** Instructors and venues can plan properly.
- ✓ **Sustainability.** Halls, insurance and music licensing all have to be paid for.
 - ✓ **Viability.** Empty rooms are how community sessions quietly disappear.
 - ✓ **Fairness.** A no-show takes a place someone else wanted.

How it works

Four steps. That is the whole thing.



What happens if you don't attend?

If you don't attend the session, your deposit is kept: no exceptions. We know that sounds firm, and it is meant to. It is the single rule that keeps the whole model working: it is why we can hold places open, book venues in advance, and keep sessions affordable for everyone else in the room.

How refunds are issued

Your deposit is refunded by **bank transfer within 24 hours of attending the session**. We use the bank details you provide at booking, and you'll get written confirmation from us. We don't refund in cash, and we don't issue credit or vouchers.

How much is the deposit?

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Deposits range from £10 to £45 depending on the session. The exact amount is always shown before you pay; you will never be charged an amount you haven't seen first.

How do I pay, and how do I get it back?

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At community stalls and events we take deposits by card tap through SumUp. Refunds are issued separately, by bank transfer, within 24 hours of you attending.

Always ask for a printed receipt or email confirmation at the point of payment. You should get one automatically; if you don't, chase us.

Do I get the full amount back?

^

● PLACEHOLDER: CONFIRM BEFORE LAUNCH

The working model in TCA's internal planning is a £10 deposit taken at a stall, with £8 (80%) returned after attendance and £2 retained to cover transaction and administration costs. That does not match "your full deposit back", so this wording needs a decision before this page goes live.

TCA to confirm: is the refund the full deposit, or the deposit minus a stated admin retention? Whichever it is, the exact figure should be stated here and at the point of payment.

What if I'm ill and can't make it?

^

● POLICY TO BE CONFIRMED

The current model states plainly that a deposit is kept if you do not attend, with no exceptions. No separate illness policy has been set yet.

TCA to confirm: whether there is any provision for illness, for example transferring a deposit to a later session with advance notice, or whether the no-exceptions rule applies in every case. We will not publish an exception that hasn't been agreed.

What if TCA cancels the session?

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● POLICY TO BE CONFIRMED

If a session is cancelled by us, no reasonable model would keep your deposit, but the exact commitment hasn't been documented in the source materials yet.

TCA to confirm: the refund timeframe and method when TCA cancels, and whether attendees are automatically moved to the next available session or refunded by default.

Why should I trust handing money to a new organisation?

Fair question, and one we'd rather you asked than swallowed. The Confidence Academy is a registered Community Interest Company. At any stall or session you should see TCA branding, our CIC registration number, and volunteers carrying written authority from us.

Always take a printed receipt or email confirmation. If any of those things are missing, don't hand over money; contact us directly first.

Is this a membership or a subscription?

Neither. There is no recurring payment, no minimum term and nothing to cancel. You book the sessions you want, one at a time.

EVENTS

What's coming up

Weekend fitness and wellbeing activities, supported by online seminars and community conversations. Join the waitlist and you'll hear about dates before they're public.

GROUP EXERCISE

Zumba & Dance Fitness

● PLACEHOLDER LISTING

📅

Date to be confirmed, weekends

🕒

Time to be confirmed

📍

Venue to be confirmed

An hour of music-led movement you can follow from the back row on your first go. No routine to learn in advance, no kit to buy.

Join the waitlist

WORKSHOP

Mindset & Resilience

● PLACEHOLDER LISTING

📅

Date to be confirmed

🕒

Time to be confirmed

📍

Venue to be confirmed

A practical session on confidence, motivation and getting back up, built around lived experience rather than theory.

Join the waitlist

ONLINE SEMINAR

Nutrition & Wellbeing

● PLACEHOLDER LISTING

📅

Date to be confirmed

🕒

Time to be confirmed

💻

Online

Straightforward, judgement-free guidance on eating well on a real budget. Bring questions.

Join the waitlist

Stories, ideas and honest conversations.

Writing from the Academy on health inequality, confidence, and what it actually takes to get moving again.

VOLUNTEER RECOGNITION

Volunteer Verification: Subinuer Kuximake

Date to be added

This post confirms that Subinuer Kuximake served as a verified volunteer with The Confidence Academy CIC, contributing time and skills in support of our work. The accompanying Volunteer Recognition Award was officially issued in acknowledgement of their genuine voluntary service.

READ POST →

PLACEHOLDER

Post title to be added

Date to be added

Standfirst or opening lines from the post go here, roughly two sentences, enough to tell a reader what the piece is about and why it's worth their time.

READ POST →

PLACEHOLDER

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READ POST →

— JOIN THE WAITLIST

Be first through the door.

We're finalising venues and dates now. Joining the waitlist costs nothing and commits you to nothing; it just means you get told first, and get first pick of places when booking opens.

- ✓ Early notice of session dates and venues
- ✓ First pick of places before they open publicly
- ✓ No payment now; you only pay a deposit when you book

Full name

Phone number

Email address

Preferred session

Pick the one you're most interested in. You can come to any of them.

Choose a session...

▼

Preferred session day

Choose the one day that suits you best.

Tuesday

Friday

Saturday

No preference

Which area are you in?

Helps us work out where to run sessions next.

Choose an area...

▼

Anything we should know? (optional)

Access needs, injuries, nerves about walking in alone, anything at all. It stays between us.

☐ Yes, contact me about upcoming Confidence Academy sessions. I can unsubscribe at any time.

Join the waitlist

No payment now. We'll only use your details to tell you about sessions.

— OUR TEAM

The Confidence Squad

A volunteer-powered team building something for their own communities. Roles and names are taken from the current TCA team structure.

LEADERSHIP



Rayhana Sultan
FOUNDER & DIRECTOR

Rayhana founded The Confidence Academy after rebuilding her own life through psychotherapy, fitness and a supportive community. A finance manager in local government, a model, and a panel advisor for the charity Working Chance, she started TCA so that other people could turn pain into power and stigma into strength.

MENTORS & ADVISORS



Andy Arthur
BUSINESS MENTOR



Hayley Chan
STUDENT ADVISOR



Mrithiyunjai Sudharshan
STUDENT MENTOR

OPERATIONS



Subi K
CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER



Mecca A
CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER

HEADS OF FUNCTION



Gideon A
HEAD OF RESEARCH & FUNDRAISING



Valentine V
HEAD OF FINANCE



Gohar A
HEAD OF EVENTS



Suvrasis P
HEAD OF BRANDS & DIGITAL

LEADS



Philip O
FUNDRAISING LEAD



Nooria A
RESEARCH LEAD



Ayokunmi S
DIGITAL & IT LEAD



Farras Z
DIGITAL & IT LEAD



Euridice Y
CREATIVE LEAD



Manya A
CREATIVE LEAD

ROLES WE'RE RECRUITING



Session Coordinators
EVENTS · VOLUNTEER

Helping run sessions on the day: set-up, welcome desk, keeping the room friendly.

[Get in touch](#)



Brand Ambassadors
BRANDS & DIGITAL · VOLUNTEER

Representing TCA at stalls and community events, and spreading the word locally.

[Get in touch](#)

CONTACT

Come and say hello.

Questions about the deposit, an access need you'd like to talk through, or interested in volunteering? Get in touch; a real person will answer.



Email
rayhana.sultan@confidenceacademy.uk



Phone
[+44 20 4569 0561](tel:+442045690561)



Registered address
82 A James Carter Rd,
Office Serv,
Mildenhall,
Suffolk, IP28 7DE



Follow us



Facebook and YouTube coming soon.

Join the waitlist



A Community Interest Company making fitness, wellbeing and confidence accessible to everyone, particularly to people who've been left out of them.

EXPLORE

- About us
- Benefits
- Deposit-refund model
- Events
- Blog
- Join the waitlist
- Our team
- Contact

GET IN TOUCH

- Email us
- +44 20 4569 0561
- Mildenhall, Suffolk